

Worksheet — Chapter 2: Nelson Mandela / A Tiger in the Zoo (Class 10 CBSE English)

Total marks: **30** · Questions: **11**

Instructions: Attempt all 11 questions. Show your reasoning where required. Total time: 50 minutes.

Q1. On what date was Mandela inaugurated as President of South Africa? [1 mark]

- (A) 27 April 1994
- (B) 10 May 1994
- (C) 12 June 1994
- (D) 16 December 1994

Q2. What does 'apartheid' mean in Afrikaans? [1 mark]

- (A) unity
- (B) separateness
- (C) brotherhood
- (D) peace

Q3. Mandela believed courage is the absence of fear. [1 mark]

- (A) True
- (B) False

Q4. Mandela was held in prison for ____ years. [1 mark]

Q5. How many stanzas does 'A Tiger in the Zoo' have? [1 mark]

- (A) three
- (B) four
- (C) five
- (D) six

Q6. Mandela's deepest insight about freedom is that: [2 marks]

- (A) only some deserve it
- (B) no one is truly free if all are not free; the oppressor is as unfree as the oppressed
- (C) only Africans deserve it
- (D) freedom is small

Q7. Describe the inauguration ceremony of Nelson Mandela on 10 May 1994. [3 marks]

Q8. What does Mandela mean by 'twin obligations'? Why could a black man not fulfil them under apartheid? [3 marks]

Q9. Describe the contrast between the caged tiger and the wild tiger in Norris's poem. [3 marks]

Q10. What does Mandela mean by saying that 'the oppressor is as unfree as the oppressed'? Discuss with examples from the chapter. [6 marks]

Q11. What unifies Mandela's prose and Norris's poem as Chapter 2 of First Flight? Discuss the chapter as a meditation on freedom. [8 marks]

Answer Key

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Q1. On what date was Mandela inaugurated as President of South Africa?

Answer: 10 May 1994

10 May 1994.

MCQ · EASY · 10-CBSE-ENG-NM-01

Q2. What does 'apartheid' mean in Afrikaans?

Answer: separateness

Separateness.

MCQ · EASY · 10-CBSE-ENG-NM-02

Q3. Mandela believed courage is the absence of fear.

Answer: False

He said it's the TRIUMPH OVER fear.

TRUE_FALSE · EASY · 10-CBSE-ENG-NM-04

Q4. Mandela was held in prison for ____ years.

Answer: 27

27 years.

FILL_BLANK · EASY · 10-CBSE-ENG-NM-02

Q5. How many stanzas does 'A Tiger in the Zoo' have?

Answer: five

Five stanzas.

MCQ · EASY · 10-CBSE-ENG-TZ-01

Q6. Mandela's deepest insight about freedom is that:

Answer: no one is truly free if all are not free; the oppressor is as unfree as the oppressed

Indivisible freedom.

MCQ · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-ENG-NM-05

Q7. Describe the inauguration ceremony of Nelson Mandela on 10 May 1994.

Answer: On 10 May 1994 at the sandstone amphitheatre of the Union Buildings in Pretoria, Mandela was inaugurated as the FIRST BLACK PRESIDENT of South Africa. He took the oath of office, joined on stage by his daughter Zenani and his deputies F.W. de Klerk and Thabo Mbeki. The new South African flag was raised; the African anthem 'Nkosi Sikelel' iAfrika' and the old anthem were sung side by side; the South African Air Force performed a fly-past. The day formally ended three centuries of white rule and the system of apartheid.

Inauguration day.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-ENG-NM-01

Q8. What does Mandela mean by 'twin obligations'? Why could a black man not fulfil them under apartheid?

Answer: Mandela writes that every man has **TWO** obligations: to his **FAMILY** and to his **PEOPLE**. In a free society, both can be fulfilled. But under apartheid, doing duty to one's people forced one into conflict with the state — at the cost of family. Children grew up without fathers (in prison or exile); fathers were stopped at the colour line. The system therefore **SHATTERED** ordinary lives, making both family and public duty impossible.

Twin obligations.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-ENG-NM-03

Q9. Describe the contrast between the caged tiger and the wild tiger in Norris's poem.

Answer: **CAGED** — paces slowly back and forth on **PADS OF VELVET** behind the **BARS OF HIS CAGE**. He **IGNORES** visitors. At night, he hears the patrol car and the silence and stares at the brilliant stars longing for a freedom he cannot have. **WILD** — slides through **LONG GRASS** in his element; **LURKS** near a **WATER-HOLE** to ambush deer; or terrorises a **VILLAGE** by snarling near its huts. The contrast is between **SLOW PACING** and **SWIFT MOVEMENT**, **BARS** and **OPEN GRASS**, **PASSIVE GAZE** and **ACTIVE HUNT** — between **CAPTIVITY** and **FREEDOM**.

Cage vs wild.

SHORT_ANSWER · MEDIUM · 10-CBSE-ENG-TZ-02

Q10. What does Mandela mean by saying that 'the oppressor is as unfree as the oppressed'? Discuss with examples from the chapter.

Answer: Mandela's insight is that **FREEDOM** is **INDIVISIBLE** — where one group denies freedom to another, **BOTH ARE TRAPPED**. The **OPPRESSED** lose vote, dignity, education, freedom of movement, often family and life. But the **OPPRESSOR** is also a prisoner — of **HATRED** (which deforms his soul), of **PREJUDICE** (which prevents him from seeing the human in the other), and of **FEAR** (the constant anxiety of maintaining a system that requires force, lies and surveillance). **EXAMPLES** — (i) White police, judges, prison guards lived their lives within a system that treated fellow humans as less than human — a daily violence to their own conscience. (ii) The white minority lived in fear of the black majority. (iii) Mandela's reconciliation with former enemies (de Klerk became his deputy) showed that releasing the oppressed also **LIBERATES** the oppressor. **WIDER MEANING** — the free society is the one where everyone is free.

Indivisibility of freedom.

LONG_ANSWER · HARD · 10-CBSE-ENG-NM-05

Q11. What unifies Mandela's prose and Norris's poem as Chapter 2 of First Flight? Discuss the chapter as a meditation on freedom.

Answer: Both pieces explore FREEDOM from OPPOSITE poles. MANDELA from the FREEDOM SIDE — the day a long imprisonment ends; the public ceremony, the new flag, the African anthem, the tribute to comrades, the embracing of former enemies, the long walk that brought him there, the long walk still ahead. The voice is calm, public, factual. NORRIS from the CAPTIVITY SIDE — the imagined eye of a tiger pacing in a zoo, alternating with images of his lost wild life. The voice is quiet, intimate, image-based. Both ask, WHAT IS FREEDOM? Mandela answers BIG — freedom is the right of an entire people to dignity, vote, future. Norris answers SMALL — freedom is the right of a wild creature to its true environment and nature. Mandela's insight that 'the oppressor is as unfree as the oppressed' connects the two pieces — just as apartheid imprisoned both blacks and whites, the tiger's cage diminishes both keeper and kept. The chapter is therefore a study of freedom at every scale — political, personal, animal. It teaches us to value freedom and recognise its absence.

Two pieces unified.

LONG_ANSWER · HARD · 10-CBSE-ENG-NM-09